



Security Watch

IE Vulnerabilities



The problem

On February 8, security firm Secunia reported multiple vulnerabilities in Internet Explorer, which can be exploited by people with malicious intent to conduct 'cross-site scripting' and phishing attacks, disclose sensitive information, bypass certain security restrictions, and compromise a user's system.

Cross-site scripting occurs when a Web application gathers data from a user. The data is usually gathered in the form of a hyperlink that has malicious content within it.

Damages

The possible damages include: (a) A hacker can spoof the address bar and execute arbitrary HTML and script code in a user's browser session. This can further be exploited to execute arbitrary code. (b) Certain vulnerabilities can be exploited to link to local resources when a user clicks a link.

Precautions

Apply the patches available from Microsoft. Here is a partial list.

For Windows XP SP1:
<http://snipurl.com/cvn9>
For IE6 on Windows XP SP2:
<http://snipurl.com/cvn9>

advantage of technology to increase efficiency. This is a major sector of focus for us. Partnerships are key, and we are delighted to work with NIIT."

PAINTING PUNE RED

Red Hat Now Has Shades Of Tricolour

Red Hat, the open source company, inaugurated its Global Engineering and Support Center at Kalyani Nagar, Pune, last month.

Red Hat CEO Mathew Szulik had flown down for the occasion. The India support centre will address the support requirements of the growing customer base in India, and also serve customers in English-speaking markets around the globe.

The Pune centre will provide services such as Web ticketing support and knowledge management, and will also

have a test lab for hardware and software certification. Also inhouse will be a localisation team that will work on the localisation of Red Hat Enterprise Linux in Indian languages.

Red Hat's Global Support Services is a 24x7 network currently located in North America, the UK and Australia. These centres address the support requirements of customers in North America, Europe and Asia. India is a new addition to the list. Speaking on the occasion, Javed Tapia, Director, Red Hat India, said, "Pune was preferred as it has a large pool of engineering talent and it met all our requirements."

Compared with other centres across the globe, the manpower in India is highly qualified and comprises mainly technical engineers. The support provided by the Pune centre is only Web-based. Besides Web-based support, the Pune centre will also

provide training for Red Hat certifications, such as Red Hat Certified Technician (RHCT), Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE) and Red Hat Certified Architect (RHCA). The centre currently employs 150.



HOT



Broadband

In late January, in a survey of almost 2,000 ad executives, brand managers and academics by online magazine Brandchannel, Apple was voted the world's most influential brand.

Google

Google has been ousted from last year's top spot in the same survey. Google has been beaten for its ability to 'capture the imagination'. Not surprisingly, Google hasn't fallen much, and comes in at second place.

NOT



Szulik is bullish about the Indian open source scene: "Indian businesses and professionals are eager to embrace open source. Also, the workforce here is very educated, energetic and qualified. Such rich resources are certainly an invitation to companies like us."

ASK JEEVES RE-EMERGES

A Firefox-based Ask Jeeves Browser?

Ask Jeeves and the Mozilla Foundation have begun discussions regarding the possibilities of a Firefox-based Jeeves browser, and of donating



One Silly Question Suggest a new name for the Motherboard!



"I think 'Power Monster' fits the bill, since it is the power centre of the PC."

Nirbhay Kothari, Rajasthan



"I would call it 'Super Tank' because it contains all devices and chips."

Sameera Shaikh, Navi Mumbai



"The paraphernalia on the motherboard is like a cobweb. 'Spiderslate' maybe?"

Nirav Shah, Dahanu



"Maybe 'Governor' as it is the main circuit board."

Prakash Sapra, Gujarat



"It combines and links everything, so 'Multi-thread device' sounds apt."

Yawar Abbas Naqvi, Delhi